

Working Conditions in Germany

Propaganda ⇒ praised workers in Germany + tried to associate them with Hitler.
Hitler ⇒ fulfilled his promise ⇒ to lower unemployment ⇒ helped to ensure Nazi popularity among industrial workers.

⇒ also tried to win their loyalty through many various initiatives.

- schemes such as *strength through joy* ⇒ gave them cheap theatre and cinema tickets, organized courses, trips and sports events, and even offered discounted cruises on luxury liners
 - 1939 ⇒ 50 million Germans had been on a KdF holiday
- *Beauty of Labor Movement* ⇒ improved working conditions in factories.
 - introduced features not seen before ⇒ washing facilities and low cost canteens.
- state scheme was introduced ⇒ to help every worker buy the Volkswagen beetle.
 - no worker ever received one ⇒ war halted car production in 1939

Workers lost their main political party ⇒ SDP

⇒ lost their trade unions ⇒ for many workers this was a source of bitter resentment

- all workers had to join DAP ⇒ run by Robert Ley
 - DAF kept strict control of workers
 - they were not allowed to strike for better pay and conditions ⇒ and sometimes they were prevented from moving to better paying jobs.

Wages ⇒ remained comparatively low ⇒ although prices of goods were also strictly controlled

late 1930 ⇒ workers were complaining that standard of living ⇒ was still lower than it had been before the depression
